windows were open and she could feel a warm breeze entering from outside. Magical. But how had the painter done it?

She searched for a name and found it not in the lower right-hand corner but in the book. *Willem Claesz. Heda*: *Still Life with a Silver Tazza*. What is a tazza? Her gaze shifted back to the painting, and through a process of deduction, she figured that one unfamiliar object, the one she couldn't attach a name to must be the tazza—a wide silver dish tipped over on its side, the light from the invisible window glinting like a sword on its rim, painfully hard so that she wanted to look away.

Rose then lifted her head from the book and realized that Viriginie had returned to the kitchen because she could hear the water running in the sink. She stared at the window, where the fading sun cast a faint glow and darkness blanketed the ground. Inside, the air shimmered with the flickering light of the candles. Light, she thought, is the key. The element she'd tried to capture on the bridge the day the German soldier chased her. She never truly understood its significance until she set her eyes on the painting by a man who had lived three hundred years ago. A man, what was his name—Heda—who could bring light, through a window only visible in a reflection on a glass, into a room which changed everything it touched: the sharp glint on the silver dish, the soft sunny bounce on the peeled lemon, the warm golden glow inside the glass of wine. Remarkable.

That night, she carried the book with the three-hundred-year-old still life to bed. She felt as if Virginie had handed her a sacred stone. Not just a work of immense technical proficiency that she couldn't even begin to do with pencil and paper (if only Madame Martin hadn't taken her pastels), but something of profound insight. Now, she had a path, one that felt true to her original intentions—sketching objects rather than people because the former were predictable; they didn't die, steal or disappear like her mother, Madame Martin and André all had. With the book next to her, Rose had fallen into a deep slumber.

Paulette clapped her hands, bringing Rose back into the moment. "What do you want to draw?" she asked.

"That depends on you," Rose said.

"Me?"

She nodded. "You will be the one to collect the items for my still life." She stood and pulled down a rattan basket hanging on the wall. "You will